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A CLEAN SWEEP

Want to make your home sparkle? Then follow these expert-backed tips and tricks

By **SHARON NATHANI**

Cleaning is a monotonous chore, but one can make it enjoyable. I put on my favourite playlist and hum along while cleaning. Plus, all that exercise makes up for not going to the gym.

But enough about me. Let's talk about seasonal deep cleaning. Trust me, it's worth it. By breaking down tasks room-wise and season-wise, you'll be amazed at how organised and clutter-free your home can become.

In spring, declutter and refresh your bedrooms—swap the heavy winter quilts with the lighter Jaipuri sheets or dohars. In summer, service the air conditioners, change the curtains to lightweight fabrics and pastel shades, get the freezer ready for all the ice-creams you will need to stock.

In autumn, as the weather cools, prepare for cosy indoor living. Deep clean carpets, flip the mattresses, clean the fans so the dirt on the edges doesn't show up when they are not in motion and deep clean the oven. Since indoor time increases in winter, pay more attention to sanitisation. Disinfect high-touch surfaces, check the heating systems. Get the warm clothes and quilts out and, above all, make space for all the unnecessary holiday decorations that you're going to buy.

As for the cleaning, I use a lot of eco-friendly natural cleaning alternatives for sustainable living and an almost chemical-free home. Baking soda, vinegar, salt, lemons are some of my favourite cleansing agents. The two things I use most are lime skins and baking soda.

Lime skins mainly in the kitchen to get grease off dishes and the microwave. You can also give them a good boil along with some whole spices to make a natural spray that keeps your home smelling great. Another great ingredient is baking soda to clean drains, wash clothes, especially whites, and to shine up silver.

Here's a pro tip for the kitchen. Boil a cup of water, add in a ball of aluminium foil, a tablespoon of baking soda and place the silverware. They will shine like new when you take them out. Happy cleaning.